

3rd Chapter

The Noble Quran

Revelation/Miracles/Compilation

Revelation and its types

Excellence and Importance of the Quran

Miracle of the Qur'an

Efforts in compilation the Holy Quran

Ms. SAFIA WAQAS

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Revelation and its types

► Topics:

- Introduction Revelation and Its Types Definition & Purpose
- Forms and Types of Revelation
 - A. Direct Speech (Without an Intermediary)
 - B. Revelation Through an Angel (Most Commonly via Jibreel)
 - C. Direct Speech (Without an Intermediary)
 - D. True Dreams (Ru'ya al-Sadiqa)
 - E. Veiled Communication (Behind a Veil)
 - F. Revelation Filling the Prophet's Heart (Wahy al-Qalb)

Introduction Revelation and Its Types

Introduction

➤ Definition of Revelation (Wahi):

In Islam, revelation is the way Allah communicates His guidance and messages to humanity. This communication is given to His chosen prophets through different forms so that people may understand and follow His commands.

➤ Purpose:

The varied forms of revelation were meant to suit different situations, contexts, and the nature of the messages being delivered.

Forms and Types of Revelation

A. Direct Speech (Without an Intermediary)

What It Is:

In this rare form, Allah speaks directly to a prophet without any intermediary such as an angel.

Examples: Prophet Musa (Moses): Allah spoke directly to Musa at Mount Sinai. The Quran mentions:

"And Allah spoke to Musa directly." (Surah An-Nisa, 4:164)
Prophet Muhammad (Mi'raj):

During the Night of Ascension (Mi'raj), Allah directly communicated with Muhammad (peace be upon him), including the ordainment of the five daily prayers.

B. Revelation Through an Angel (Most Commonly via Jibreel)

- 1. What It Is:** The most common way prophets received revelation was through an angel, usually Angel Jibreel (Gabriel). He is known as the "messenger to the messengers."

Example:

The entire Quran was revealed to Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) through Jibreel, as indicated in the verse:

"Say, [O Muhammad], 'Whoever is an enemy to Gabriel...'"

(Surah Al-Baqarah, 2:97)

Forms of Angelic Revelation:

1. As a Human:

Sometimes, Jibreel appeared in the form of a man. An example of this is seen in the well-known Hadith where he questioned Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) about Islam, Iman (faith), and Ihsan (excellence).

2. Unseen but Audible:

There were times when the Prophet only heard Jibreel's voice, without seeing him, receiving the message as a sound or resonance.

3. True Angelic Form:

On a couple of occasions, Jibreel appeared in his true form, displaying such a majestic presence that he filled the entire horizon.

C. Direct Speech (Without an Intermediary)

What It Is:

Sometimes, Allah directly fills the heart of a prophet with divine guidance or knowledge. This inner inspiration, known as Ilham, does not involve any physical or audible form.

Examples:

The mother of Prophet Musa received divine guidance instructing her to place her baby in a basket in the river for his protection.

""And We inspired to the mother of Moses, 'Suckle him; but when you fear for him, cast him into the river...""(Surah Al-Qasas, 28:7)

D. True Dreams (Ru'ya al-Sadiqa)

What It Is:

True dreams are a special form of revelation, different from regular dreams. They serve as a way for prophets to receive important messages.

Examples 1: Prophet Ibrahim (Abraham):

He saw in a dream that he must sacrifice his son, Ismail, as a command from Allah.

""And when he reached with him [the age of] exertion, he said, 'O my son, indeed I have seen in a dream...""(Surah As-Saffat, 37:102)

Examples 2: Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him):

Early in his prophethood, the Prophet began receiving true dreams which were later followed by the angelic revelation of the Quran.

E. Veiled Communication (Behind a Veil)

What It Is:

In this form, Allah's communication is delivered in a way that His presence is not directly seen, maintaining a respectful distance.

Examples:

When Prophet Musa encountered the burning bush, Allah spoke from behind it.

"And when he came to it, he was called, 'O Moses, indeed I am your Lord, so remove your sandals...'"(Surah Ta-Ha, 20:11-12)

F. Revelation Filling the Prophet's Heart (Wahy al-Qalb)

What It Is:

This type of revelation occurs when the prophet's heart is filled with divine knowledge and guidance. It is an internal experience, not necessarily linked to a spoken word or vision.

Examples:

This form is linked to the comprehensive guidance that filled Prophet Muhammad's (peace be upon him) heart. Even in times when specific verses were not being revealed, his heart was full of divine insight that enabled him to lead and provide guidance.

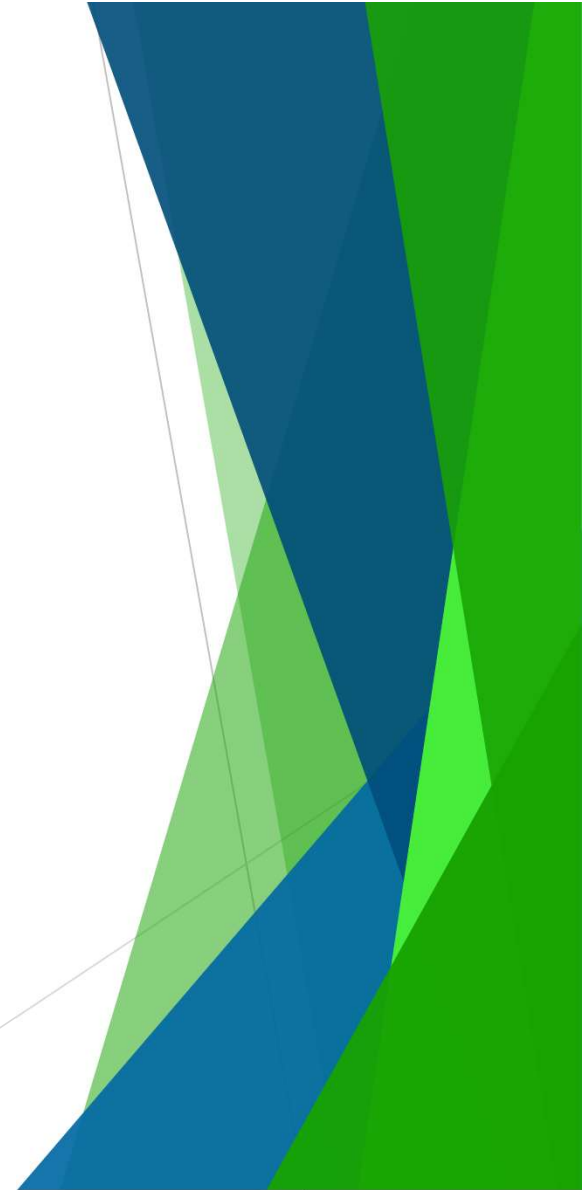
The diverse forms of revelation highlight the unique ways Allah chose to communicate with His prophets. Whether it was through direct speech, angelic messages, inner inspiration, true dreams, veiled communication, or filling the heart, each method was meant to suit the specific needs and circumstances of the time.

Understanding these forms helps us appreciate the depth and variety of divine communication in Islam, and it reinforces the special role that prophets played in guiding humanity.

Excellence and Importance of the Quran

► Topics:

- Introduction and Why the Quran is Special
- Quranic Verses on the Importance of the Quran
 - A. Guidance and Light for Humanity
 - B. Clear Evidence
 - C. Healing and Mercy
 - D. Reminder for Mankind
 - E. Protection and Preservation by Allah
- Hadiths on the Importance of the Quran
 - A. Superiority of the Quran
 - B. Intercession on the Day of Judgment
 - C. Elevating Status in Paradise
 - D. Reward for Reciting
 - E. Heart's Illumination
 - F. Guidance and Relief from Darkness

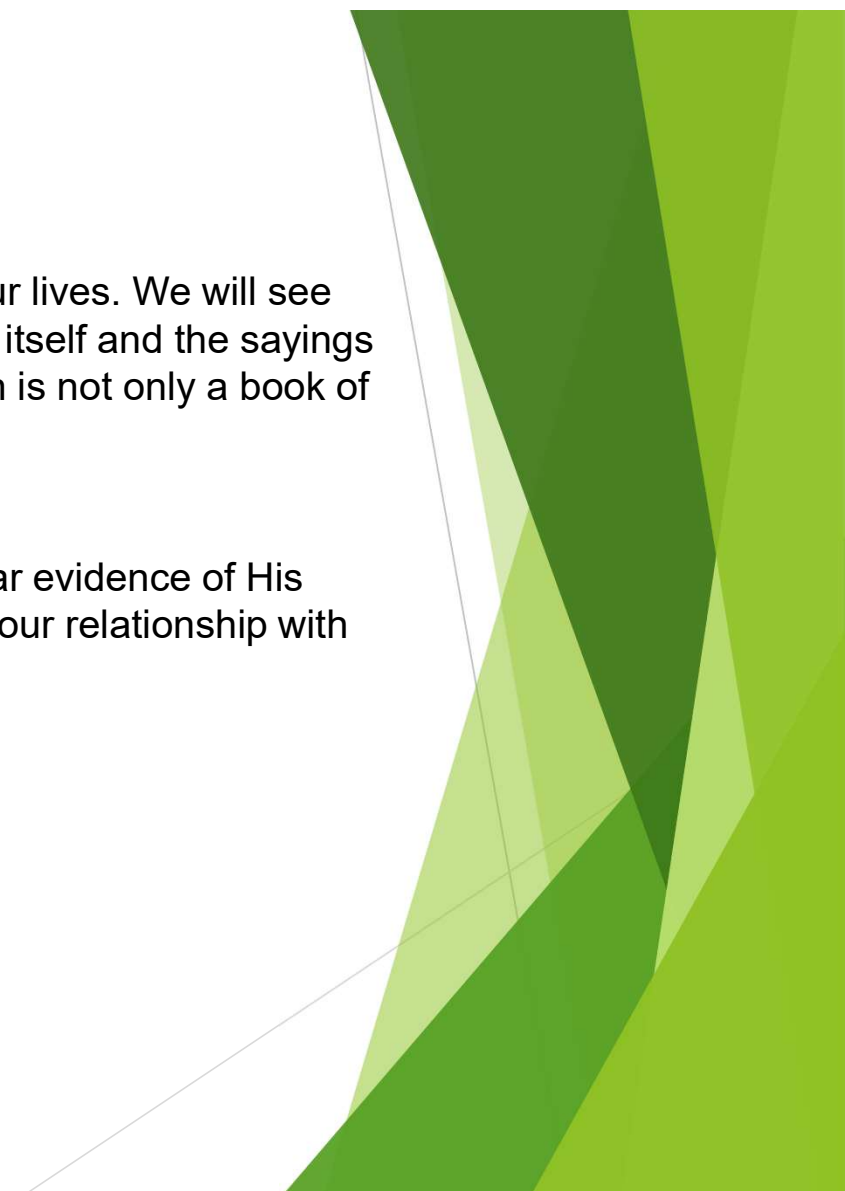


Introduction

In this lecture, we will explore the unique role of the Holy Quran in our lives. We will see how its excellence and importance are highlighted in both the Quran itself and the sayings (Hadith) of the Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him). The Quran is not only a book of guidance but also a source of light, healing, and protection.

Why the Quran is Special:

The Quran is regarded as the final revelation from Allah, offering clear evidence of His mercy, wisdom, and guidance. It shapes our morals, spirituality, and our relationship with Allah.



Quranic Verses on the Importance of the Quran

A. Guidance and Light for Humanity

Quran Verse:

"This is the Book about which there is no doubt, a guidance for those conscious of Allah."

(Surah Al-Baqarah, 2:2)

This verse reminds us that the Quran is a clear source of guidance for all believers, leading us to a path of righteousness.

B. Clear Evidence

Quran Verse:

"O mankind, there has come to you a conclusive proof from your Lord, and we have sent down to you a clear light."

(Surah An-Nisa, 4:174)

The Quran acts as undeniable evidence from Allah, illuminating the truth for everyone.

C. Healing and Mercy

Quran Verse:

""And we send down from the Quran that which is healing and mercy for the believers..."

(Surah Al-Isra, 17:82)

This verse explains how the Quran provides spiritual healing and shows Allah's mercy to all who believe.

D. Reminder for Mankind

Quran Verse:

"Indeed, we have sent down to you a Book in which is your mention. Then will you not reason?"

(Surah Al-Anbiya, 21:10)

The Quran is a reminder of our existence, our duties, and our purpose in life, prompting us to think and reflect.

E. Protection and Preservation by Allah

Quran Verse:

"Indeed, it is we who sent down the Quran, and indeed, We will be its guardian."

(Surah Al-Hijr, 15:9)

This verse assures us that Allah protects the Quran from any alteration, preserving its original message for all time.

Hadiths on the Importance of the Quran

A. Superiority of the Quran

Hadith:

The Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) said:

**"The best of you are those who learn the Quran and teach it."
(Sahih al-Bukhari)**

This express that those who study and share the Quran are held in high honor

B. Intercession on the Day of Judgment

Hadith:

The Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) said:

**"Recite the Quran, for it will come as an intercessor for its reciters on the Day of Resurrection."
(Sahih Muslim)**

The Quran will advocate for its readers on the Day of Judgment, highlighting its role as a protector and helper.

C. Elevating Status in Paradise

Hadith:

The Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) said:

"It will be said to the companion of the Quran (one who memorizes or frequently recites the Quran), 'Recite and ascend (in ranks), as you used to recite when you were in the world. Your rank will be at the last verse you recite.'"
(Sunan Abu Dawood)

This hadith shows that the more one engages with the Quran, the higher their status in Paradise.

D. Reward for Reciting

Hadith:

The Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) said:

"Whoever recites a letter from the Book of Allah will receive a good deed as ten times its like. I do not say that Alif-Laam-Meem is a letter, but Alif is a letter, Laam is a letter, and Meem is a letter."
(Sunan At-Tirmidhi)

This encourages us to recite the Quran, as every letter brings immense rewards.

E. Heart's Illumination

Hadith:

The Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) said:

""Indeed, the one who does not have anything of the Quran in his heart is like a ruined house.""

(Sunan At-Tirmidhi)

This emphasizes that a heart filled with the Quran is like a well-maintained home, full of light and life.

The Quran and Hadith highlight the Quran's unmatched excellence. It is a guide, a source of light, healing, and protection, and it carries immense rewards for those who read, memorize, and teach it. The Quran not only directs us in our daily lives but also offers spiritual intercession and elevates our status in the hereafter.

Embracing the teachings of the Quran brings us closer to Allah, fills our hearts with wisdom, and prepares us for the eternal life in Paradise. Let us strive to learn, reflect upon, and share the divine message contained in the Holy Quran.

F. Guidance and Relief from Darkness

Hadith:

The Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) said:

""I leave behind me two things: the Quran and my Sunnah, and if you follow these, you will never go astray.""

(Muwatta Malik)

Following the Quran and the Prophet's Sunnah ensures that we are guided correctly and protected from the errors of life.

Miracle of the Qur'an

► Topics:

- Introduction and Importance and Usefulness of the Miracle of the Qur'an
 - A. Proof of Divine Origin
 - B. Source of Guidance and Strong belief
 - C. Inspiration for Reflection and Study
 - D. Preservation of the Arabic Language and Culture
 - E. Moral and Spiritual Motivation
 - F. Evidence for Prophethood
 - G. Scientific I'jaz and the Encouragement of Knowledge

Introduction and Importance and Usefulness of the Miracle of the Qur'an

Introduction

In this topic, we will discuss the miracle of the Qur'an (I'jaz al-Qur'an). This concept highlights the Qur'an's divine origin and its unique qualities that no human can replicate. It serves as strong evidence of Allah's revelation to Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) and strengthens the faith of believers.

A. Proof of Divine Origin

The miracle of the Qur'an shows that it is a divine revelation from Allah. Its language, wisdom, and structure are unmatched.

Qur'anic Challenge:

Allah challenges doubters by saying:
“And if you are in doubt about what We have sent down upon Our Servant, then produce a surah the like thereof and call upon your witnesses other than Allah, if you should be truthful.”
(Surah Al-Baqarah, 2:23)

Explanation:

This challenge, which remains unmet for over 1400 years, confirms that the Qur'an is beyond human ability and is truly from Allah.

B. Source of Guidance and Conviction

The miraculous nature of the Qur'an reinforces the belief and conviction of Muslims.

Explanation:

Knowing that the Qur'an is a divine miracle helps believers appreciate its guidance and encourages them to follow its teachings sincerely, knowing that its wisdom comes directly from Allah.

C. Inspiration for Reflection and Study

The miracle of the Qur'an inspires both scholars and ordinary people to study and reflect upon its verses.

Explanation:

Its unique language and deep meanings have given rise to fields like tafsir (interpretation) and balagha (eloquence). This constant study not only enriches our understanding but also promotes lifelong learning and intellectual growth.

D. Preservation of the Arabic Language and Culture

The Qur'an's linguistic excellence has played a major role in preserving the Arabic language.

Explanation:

Its smoothness, structure, and poetic style set high standards in Arabic literature. As a result, the classical Arabic language remains preserved and continues to be a vital part of Arabic culture and heritage.

E. Moral and Spiritual Motivation

Understanding the Qur'an as a divine miracle motivates Muslims to adhere to its guidance.

Explanation:

Knowing that the message is miraculous and divinely prescribed encourages believers to follow its moral teachings with dedication, leading to a fulfilling and righteous life.

F. Evidence for Prophethood

The miracle of the Qur'an serves as a strong argument for the prophethood of Muhammad (peace be upon him).

Explanation:

Although Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) was "unlettered" (ummi) and did not know how to read or write, the Qur'an's unmatched beauty and depth clearly indicate that it must have come from Allah, thus confirming his prophethood.

G. Scientific I'jaz and the Encouragement of Knowledge

Some aspects of the Qur'an include knowledge about the natural world and cosmic phenomena that were unknown at the time.

Qur'anic Reference:

“We will show them Our signs in the horizons and within themselves until it becomes clear to them that it is the truth...”

(Surah Fussilat, 41:53)

Explanation:

These references encourage Muslims to pursue scientific research and knowledge. They show that faith and science can go hand in hand, inspiring discovery and understanding of the world.

The miracle of the Qur'an is a powerful reminder of its divine origin and its supreme excellence. It provides clear evidence of Allah's revelation, strengthens the faith of believers, inspires continuous study and reflection, preserves the Arabic language, motivates moral and spiritual behavior, and even supports the scientific quest for knowledge.

The Qur'an is not only a book of guidance but also a timeless miracle that continues to enrich the lives of Muslims around the world, bridging the gap between the divine and human understanding.

Efforts in Compilation of the Holy Quran

► Topics:

- Introduction Compilation During the Lifetime of Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him)

- A. Oral Memorization
- B. Written Recordings
- C. Verification by the Prophet

Compilation During the Caliphate of Abu Bakr (may Allah be pleased with him) - Need for a Single Book

- A. Leadership by Zaid ibn Thabit
- B. Stringent Collection Process
- C. Completion of the Mus'haf

Compilation During the Caliphate of Uthman (may Allah be pleased with him) - Need for Standardization

- A. Formation of a Committee
- B. Standardization and Distribution
- C. Preservation of Dialects
- D. Importance of the Compilation Efforts

Introduction Compilation During the Lifetime of Prophet Muhammad

The Holy Quran was revealed gradually over 23 years. From the beginning, special care was taken to keep its words safe and unchanged. In this lesson, we will learn about the three main stages in the compilation process.

Compilation During the Lifetime of Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him)

How It Was Preserved During the Prophet's Time:

The Quran was not written as one complete book during the Prophet's lifetime. It was recorded in many different ways, including being memorized by his companions and written down on various materials.

A. Oral Memorization

Explanation:

Many companions of the Prophet memorized the Quran exactly as it was revealed. This tradition, called hifz (memorization), was very important because the Arabs had a strong oral tradition.

B. Written Recordings

Explanation:

The Prophet asked his scribes to write down the verses on different materials such as parchment, leather, stones, and bones. These writings were carefully arranged as the verses were revealed.

C. Verification by the Prophet

Explanation:

The Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) would often review the verses with Angel Jibreel (Gabriel). In his final year, he conducted a final review called “Al-Ardah al-Akhirah” to confirm the order and correctness of the verses.

Compilation During the Caliphate of Abu Bakr (may Allah be pleased with him)

Need for a Single Book: After the Prophet passed away, many of those who memorized the Quran (huffaz) were martyred in the Battle of Yamama. This made it urgent to collect the verses into one written manuscript.

A. Leadership by Zaid ibn Thabit

Explanation:

Caliph Abu Bakr appointed Zaid ibn Thabit, a trusted scribe, to collect the verses because of his deep knowledge of the Quran.

B. Stringent Collection Process

Explanation:

Zaid gathered all the written pieces from various sources. He then checked every verse with several witnesses who had memorized the Quran to make sure everything was correct.

C. Completion of the Mus'haf

Explanation:

After careful verification, all the verses were organized into one complete book, known as the Mus'haf. This Mus'haf was first kept by Caliph Abu Bakr, then passed on to Caliph Umar, and later to Hafsa bint-e-Umar, one of the Prophet's widows.

Compilation During the Caliphate of Uthman (may Allah be pleased with him)

Need for Standardization: As Islam spread to many regions, differences in dialects started to appear in the recitation of the Quran.

To avoid confusion, Caliph Uthman decided to create a standard copy.

A. Formation of a Committee

Caliph Uthman formed a committee led by Zaid ibn Thabit along with other knowledgeable companions. Their task was to use the Mus'haf from Abu Bakr as the base.

B. Standardization and Distribution

The committee produced several identical copies of the Quran, known as Uthmanic codices. These copies were sent to major Islamic centers like Makkah, Kufa, Basra, and Damascus.

C. Preservation of Dialects

The standardized text was based on the Quraish dialect—the same dialect spoken by the Prophet. This helped in keeping the recitation uniform for all Muslims.

D. Importance of the Compilation Efforts

These careful efforts ensured that the Quran has been preserved in its original, unaltered form. Today, Muslims around the world read and memorize the same text, just as it was compiled and verified in the early days of Islam.

The preservation and compilation of the Quran occurred in three clear stages:

During the Prophet's Lifetime: Through memorization, writing, and regular verification.

During Caliph Abu Bakr's Time: With the urgent collection led by Zaid ibn Thabit after many huffaz were lost.

During Caliph Uthman's Time: By standardizing and distributing the text across the Muslim world.

These efforts show the great care and dedication early Muslims had in keeping the words of Allah safe. The result is the Quran we have today—a timeless and accurate guide for all generations.